

TENEX.AI

Cybersecurity · AI-native Managed Detection & Response · Sarasota, Florida · Private (>\$1B reported; \$250M Series B, Mar 2026)

TENEX.AI, the Sarasota-based AI-native security operations firm, closed a \$250M Series B led by Crosspoint Capital Partners on 31 March 2026 at a valuation Bloomberg put above \$1B, a year after its first customer contract, and named former Charles Schwab CISO Bashar Abouseido President the same day.

71

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 31 March 2026 TENEX.AI announced a \$250M Series B led by Crosspoint Capital Partners, with Shield Capital and DeepWork Capital, at a valuation Bloomberg reported above \$1B. The company stated \$25M of contracted revenue within a year of launch and 318% year-on-year growth, first on IT-Harvest's 2026 Cyber 150. The capital funds 250-plus hires in 2026, expansion into Europe, the Middle East and Africa, and deeper Google Cloud SecOps and Microsoft Sentinel integrations. The same day it named former Charles Schwab CISO Bashar Abouseido President. **A UNICORN BUILDING A GLOBAL BRAND FROM FLORIDA.**

Cybersecurity is the most contested technology lane in Formula 1: CrowdStrike at Mercedes, Keeper at Williams, Bitdefender at Ferrari, Red Bull's 1Password, Okta at McLaren, Cato Networks at Alpine and NinjaOne at Audi, with the SentinelOne seat at Aston Martin newly vacated. Managed detection and response is a different product: a round-the-clock security operations service. That leaves Haas, Racing Bulls and Cadillac as open seats, one of them starting from nothing.

WHY NOW

The Series B closed on 31 March; a brand budget sized for 250-plus hires and an EMEA launch is being set this quarter. Cadillac settles its second-season partner roster between the summer break and the United States GP in Austin, so an approach in May lands before the 2027 inventory is priced.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$250M

\$250M Series B led by Crosspoint Capital Partners with Shield Capital and DeepWork Capital, announced 31 Ma...

\$25M

\$25M contracted revenue within a year of launch (company statement in the 31 Mar 2026 Series B release)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team ◆ RECOMMENDED	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	CrowdStrike
Atlassian Williams Racing	TAKEN	Keeper
Oracle Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$250M Series B at a reported \$1B-plus valuation, a president hired from Charles Schwab and a 250-hire, EMEA-bound growth plan put TENEX.AI at the moment a brand platform gets funded. Cadillac's debut roster has no security partner, and the SOC it needs is the product TENEX.AI sells.

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac has no cybersecurity partner and no legacy security stack: its 2026 roster is entirely inaugural, IFS runs the operations software, Core Scientific the data centre and TWG AI the models, and the seat for the service that watches over all of it is open. A debut American team, run from Silverstone while Fishers and Charlotte come online, is standing up its security operation now, exactly when an AI-native SOC is bought. TENEX.AI's Fortune 500 buyers are the audience in the Austin and Las Vegas suites.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. A race team's attack surface is its data: design files at Silverstone, telemetry from every circuit, supplier links into GM. TENEX.AI would run the team's security operations centre: AI agents triaging every alert, human analysts governing response, cover across US and UK time zones, an incident-response retainer for race weekends, and integration with the Google or Microsoft security tooling the team standardises on. On camera: the pit-wall data it protects.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Cybersecurity Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, covering the move into Fishers and a possible listing window. Estimated \$2-4M a year, part in service value. Scope: sidepod or halo placement, naming of the team's security operations centre, Miami, Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for CISO customers, a co-authored case study on securing a team from day one.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Eric Foster

FOUNDER & CEO, TENEX.AI · **VERIFIED**

Foster founded TENEX.AI after three CISO tours and a presidency at Stairwell; he fronts every raise. Path: Bashar Abouseido, President since 31 March 2026; Ryan Shreve, Co-Founder, CFO and COO. No CMO was listed at this date; Richard Rogers joined as CMO on 4 June 2026.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the greenfield roster.

“Eric, Cadillac is building a Formula 1 team's IT from nothing and has no security partner; CrowdStrike and Keeper took their seats years ago. A debut team's SOC is a story only one company gets to tell. 25 minutes?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 Round closed 31 Mar; Miami just passed.	CAPACITY 13 / 20 \$250M raised; \$25M contracted revenue is thin.	BRAND FIT 13 / 20 B2B security brand; US debut-team story.	URGENCY 14 / 20 250 hires, EMEA launch; no hard deadline.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: SOC for a greenfield team.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

SCALE VERSUS DEAL SIZE \$25M of contracted revenue makes a mid-tier F1 fee a large share of the business. **Counter:** Take part of the fee in service value and stage cash against the 2027 roster.

VALUATION IS REPORTED The above-\$1B valuation is Bloomberg's, absent from the company release. **Counter:** Anchor on the \$250M round and \$25M contracted revenue, both company-stated; confirm on the call.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- <https://tenex.ai/news/series-b/>
- <https://tenex.ai/meet-the-tenexers/>
- <https://www.businessobserverfl.com/news/2026/may/15/entrepreneur-eric-foster/>